

KEY TOPIC 2: HITLER'S RISE TO POWER, 1919-33

Assessment Question: From Democracy to Dictatorship: How did Hitler destroy the Weimar Republic?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922			
L2: KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929			
L3: KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932			
L4: KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the 25-Point Programme and explain how it was designed to appeal to multiple different groups in German society.
- ☐ Analyse the methods Adolf Hitler used to take total control of the party, including his public speaking, party restructuring, and early propaganda.
- ☐ Evaluate the role and impact of the SA (Sturmabteilung), explaining how political violence became a core tactic of the early Nazi Party.

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

DAP (German Workers' Party) | NSDAP (National Socialist German Workers' Party) | 25-Point Programme | Nationalism | Socialism | SA (Sturmabteilung) | Stosstrupp (Shock Troop) | Völkischer Beobachter

In 1919, Anton Drexler founded the tiny _____. A year later, Hitler rebranded it as the _____ and helped write the _____. This manifesto blended extreme _____ with ideas of _____ to appeal to the working class. To spread their message, the party purchased the _____ newspaper. By 1921, Hitler set up the _____ to protect meetings, but later created an elite _____ as his personal bodyguard.

Active Tasks

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q1. Complete the following sentences based on the provided narrative: 1) Hitler joined the DAP in 1919 BUT... 2) The DAP changed its name to NSDAP in 1920 BECAUSE... 3) The SA was formed in 1921 SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Write a short paragraph (approx. 75-100 words) describing the early development of the Nazi Party, ensuring you use at least FIVE of the following keywords: DAP, NSDAP, 25-Point Programme, Nationalism, Socialism, SA, Stosstrupp, Völkischer Beobachter.

Causal Linkage

Q3. Explain the causal link between Hitler's leadership and the rapid growth and radicalisation of the Nazi Party between 1919 and 1922. How did his actions directly contribute to these outcomes?

Counter-Factual History

Q4. Imagine that the **SA**** (Sturmabteilung) was never formed, or was quickly suppressed by authorities, during the 1919-1922 period. How might the early development of the Nazi Party have differed significantly, and what implications would this have had for its ability to gain influence?**

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. 2. Explain why the Nazi Party grew in support between 1919 and 1922 (12 marks).

You may use the following in your answer:

- **Hitler's oratorical skills**
- **The 25-Point Programme**

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):

From a diary of an early party member, Munich, 1921.

"When Hitler took the platform, the entire beer hall was silent with anticipation. He spoke for nearly two hours, moving from a slow, quiet whisper to a booming, furious rage against the treaty. His intense gaze and violent hand gestures drew everyone in. By the end, men and women were in tears, completely captured by his absolute belief that he was the savior of Germany."

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):

From the official DAP Twenty-Five Point Programme, declared February 1920.

"We demand the immediate destruction of the Treaty of Versailles and the unification of all Germans in a Greater Germany. We demand land and colonies to feed our population. Only those of German blood can be citizens; therefore, no Jew may be a citizen. The state's primary duty is to provide jobs and livelihoods for citizens."

Interpretation 1 (The Structured Ideology View):

The rapid expansion of the early Nazi Party was fundamentally driven by the targeted appeal of its 25-Point Programme. By cleverly combining aggressive nationalism, extreme anti-Semitism, and socialist welfare promises, the manifesto acted as a highly effective catch-all document. It offered simple, clear solutions and immediate scapegoats to multiple disgruntled classes, particularly the demobilized soldiers and lower middle class.

Interpretation 2 (The Charismatic Oratory View):

The Nazi Party's program was largely secondary to the hypnotic, personal magnetism of Adolf Hitler. In a politically chaotic Bavaria, Hitler emerged as a dynamic, modern communicator who rehearsed his speeches theatrically to project strength and conviction. It was his unique oratorical star power, combined with the physical violence of Ernst Röhm's SA, that attracted members and secured his absolute leadership over the movement.

2. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party, 1919-1922? (8 marks)

3. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

4. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

5. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. (16 marks)

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Teacher Comment:

L2: KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the short-term and long-term causes, events, and immediate consequences of the 1923 Munich Putsch.
- ☐ Analyse how Hitler used his time in prison to write Mein Kampf and fundamentally change the strategy and structure of the Nazi Party.
- ☐ Evaluate why the Nazi Party struggled to win electoral support between 1924 and 1928, despite their highly effective internal reorganisation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the name of the elite, highly trusted unit selected from the SA to act as Hitler's personal bodyguard in 1923?

2. What does the German word 'Putsch' mean?

3. Who was the Chancellor of Germany in late 1923 who called off passive resistance in the Ruhr?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about how hyperinflation created 'winners' and 'losers' in German society.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

The Bavarian Triumvirate | Treason | Landsberg Prison | Mein Kampf ('My Struggle') | Führerprinzip (The Leadership Principle) | Gauleiter | SS (Schutzstaffel) | Aryan

Your Sentence:

Active Tasks

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q1. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative:

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Using at least FOUR of the following keywords – *Mein Kampf*, Führerprinzip, Gauleiter, SS, Aryan, Landsberg Prison, Treason – explain how Hitler used his time in prison and the subsequent "Lean Years" to reshape the Nazi Party and its ideology.

Causal Linkage

Q3. Explain how the failure of the Munich Putsch and Hitler's subsequent imprisonment, despite being a setback, ultimately strengthened his position and the long-term trajectory of the Nazi Party.

The 'What If' Challenge

Q4. Imagine a counter-factual scenario where the Bavarian Triumvirate (Kahr, Lossow, Seisser) had *not* reneged on their initial agreement with Hitler during the Munich Putsch, and instead had supported his 'national revolution'. What might have been the immediate and long-term consequences for Germany, the Weimar Republic, and the rise of Nazism? Consider both political and social impacts.

Exam Practice

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):

From a letter written by a local Nazi party organizer in Hanover, May 1928.
"Our election results are an absolute disaster; we have won only twelve seats in the Reichstag, and the public completely ignores us. People are happy with Stresemann's American loans and do not want to hear our warnings. But we must not lose heart. Our party is now highly organized, we have divided Germany into Gaue, and we have established our own youth and professional leagues. We are waiting for the economic storm to break."

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):

From notes taken at the Nazi Party conference in Bamberg, February 1926.
"The Leader spoke for over two hours, asserting that there can be no division within our ranks. He declared that the NSDAP must be run strictly according to the Führerprinzip (the Leadership Principle), which demands absolute, unquestioning obedience to him as the supreme leader. The socialist proposals of the northern Gauleiters have been completely rejected, and the 25-Point Programme is declared unalterable."

Interpretation 1 (The Political Failure View):

During the era of economic stabilization, the Nazi Party was an irrelevant, failing extremist group whose message was treated as a joke by the vast majority of voters. With hyperinflation resolved and national pride partially restored under Stresemann, support for political extremism withered away, leaving the NSDAP as a spent force that was largely ignored by the German public.

Interpretation 2 (The Vital Reorganization View):

The period between 1924 and 1928 was a highly successful and vital era of party reorganization. By establishing regional Gaue, creating a centralized bureaucracy, and asserting absolute control under the Führerprinzip, Hitler transformed a chaotic paramilitary group into a highly disciplined, national political machine ready to exploit a future economic crisis.

2. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928? (8 marks)

3. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

4. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

5. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. (16 marks)

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General Notes

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Teacher Comment:

L3: KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the economic and social impacts of the 1929 Wall Street Crash on Germany.
- ☐ Analyse the political paralysis of the Weimar Republic, explaining why the collapse of Müller's coalition and Brüning's policies caused voters to flock to extremist parties.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the surge in Nazi support, judging the relative importance of Hitler's personal appeal, Goebbels' propaganda, Big Business funding, and the violence of the SA.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was Gustav Stresemann's famous quote warning about the fragility of the German economy during the 'Golden Age'?

2. What was the central message of the Führerprinzip (Leadership Principle)?

3. How many seats did the Nazi Party win in the 1928 Reichstag elections, proving they were an electoral failure before the Depression?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about how Hitler completely reorganised the Nazi Party after he was released from Landsberg Prison.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **The Wall Street Crash**

Active Tasks

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q1. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative: 1) The Grand Coalition government under Hermann Müller collapsed BUT... 2) Heinrich Brüning increasingly relied on Article 48 BECAUSE... 3) Nazi support grew dramatically between 1929 and 1932 SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Write a short paragraph (approximately 100-150 words) explaining the political and economic crisis in Germany between 1929-1932, accurately using at least five of the following keywords: Wall Street Crash, Hermann Müller, Heinrich Brüning, Article 48, KPD, Negative Cohesion, Rotfrontkämpferbund.

Prioritising Causes

Q3. Identify and explain the *two most significant* reasons for the rapid growth of Nazi support between 1929 and 1932, justifying your choices with specific evidence from the lesson narrative.

Counter-Factual History

Q4. "If the Wall Street Crash had not occurred in October 1929, the Nazis would never have come to power." To what extent do you agree with this statement? Justify your answer with reference to the lesson narrative, considering both arguments for and against the statement.

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. 2. Explain why Nazi support grew between 1929–1932 (12 marks).

You may use the following in your answer:

- **The impact of the Great Depression**
- **Hitler's charismatic appeal and propaganda**

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source): From the diary of Luise Solmitz, a schoolteacher in Hamburg, March 1932.

There stood Hitler in a simple black coat, looking over the crowd of 120,000 people of all classes and ages. A forest of swastika flags unfurled, the joy of this moment showed itself in roaring salute. The crowd looked up to show Hitler with touching faith, as their helper, their savior, their deliverer from unbearable distress. He is the rescuer of the scholar, the farmer, the worker, and the unemployed.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From an article describing the conditions of the unemployed in Berlin, 1931.

The municipal lodging houses are filled to capacity with young, unemployed men. They completely fill the streets, standing or lying about in silence. The streets are grey, their faces are grey, and even the hair on their heads and the stubble on the cheeks of the youngest there was grey with dust and their adversity. They have lost all hope, having been completely abandoned by the Weimar government's welfare cuts.

Interpretation 1 (The Economic Depression View):

The Nazi rise to power was fundamentally caused by the catastrophic economic distress of the Great Depression. The sudden withdrawal of US loans caused businesses to collapse and pushed unemployment over 6 million, which completely paralyzed the democratic system and forced desperate voters to turn to extremist parties. Without this economic crisis, the Nazis would have remained on the political margins.

Interpretation 2 (The Hitler's Charisma View):

The primary driver behind the surge in Nazi support was the unique, charismatic appeal of Adolf Hitler. At a time of intense national despair, Hitler brilliantly projected himself as a dynamic, modern, and strong leader who stood above traditional party politics. His powerful public speaking and carefully staged campaigns convinced Germans of all classes that he alone understood their personal suffering and could rescue the nation.

2. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932? (8 marks)

3. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

4. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

5. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 about the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. (16 marks)

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Teacher Comment:

L4: KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise chronological knowledge of the rapid succession of Weimar Chancellors between 1930 and 1933 (Brüning, von Papen, von Schleicher).
- ☐ Analyse the political scheming ("backstairs intrigue") between President Hindenburg, his inner circle, Franz von Papen, and the conservative elites.
- ☐ Evaluate why Hindenburg finally agreed to appoint Hitler as Chancellor despite his deep personal hatred for him, understanding the fatal miscalculation the elites made.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. How many votes did Hitler win in the 1932 Presidential election against Hindenburg?

2. What is meant by the historical term 'negative cohesion'?

3. Who was the Weimar Chancellor from 1930–1932 known bitterly as the 'Hunger Chancellor'?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about how the SA helped the Nazis gain middle-class votes during the Great Depression.

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Paul von Hindenburg | The Camarilla | Franz von Papen | Kurt von Schleicher | Backstairs Intrigue | Cabinet

By 1932, the ageing President _____ was heavily influenced by a small group of advisors known as _____. After the fall of Brüning, the President appointed the conservative _____ as Chancellor, but he lacked support. Following the brief and disastrous Chancellorship of _____, Papen engaged in _____—secretly plotting to make Hitler Chancellor. The elites severely underestimated Hitler; they believed that by restricting the number of Nazis in the _____, they could easily control him.

Active Tasks

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q1. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson:

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how Hitler became Chancellor, making sure to use ALL the following keywords: Paul von Hindenburg, The Camarilla, Franz von Papen, Kurt von Schleicher, Backstairs Intrigue, Cabinet. You may underline or bold the keywords in your answer.

Prioritising Causes

Q3. Of the factors described in the lesson, which do you think was the *most* important in Hitler becoming Chancellor? Explain your reasoning. Then, identify one *other* important factor and explain its significance.

Counter-Factual History

Q4. Imagine that President Hindenburg had refused to meet with Franz von Papen and Hitler in early January 1933, or had simply dismissed Papen's proposals outright. What do you think would have been the most likely immediate political consequences for Germany? Consider the roles of Schleicher, the Nazi Party, and the broader political climate.

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. 2. Explain why Hitler became Chancellor in January 1933. (12 marks)

You may use the following in your answer:

- The political instability of the Weimar Republic
- The role of conservative elites

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source): From a letter written by Franz von Papen to President Hindenburg, January 1933.

The only way to resolve the political deadlock is to appoint Hitler as Chancellor of a coalition cabinet. I have agreed to serve as Vice-Chancellor, and the majority of cabinet ministers will be conservative. Your Excellency need not fear his radicalism; we have pushed Hitler so far into a corner that we will easily be able to control him like a puppet.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From a dispatch by an American journalist stationed in Berlin, December 1932.

The political gridlock is absolute. Chancellor von Schleicher has failed, and the streets are ruled by daily, violent battles between communist and Nazi paramilitaries. The public has completely lost faith in democracy. The government rules solely through unpopular emergency decrees, and the weary voice of the President is completely ignored.

Interpretation 1 (The Democratic Collapse View):

Hitler's rise to power was the inevitable result of the collapse of the Weimar democratic system. The Great Depression permanently paralyzed the Reichstag, forcing a reliance on Article 48 presidential emergency decrees that destroyed democratic legitimacy. By 1932, democracy was already dead, and the conservative elites had to hand power to Hitler because his party was the largest in the parliament.

Interpretation 2 (The Political Intrigue View):

Hitler's appointment as Chancellor was not inevitable, but was the direct result of secret political scheming and backstairs intrigue. The Nazi vote was actually declining by late 1932, and the party was running out of money. Hitler was only rescued because Franz von Papen, President Hindenburg, and conservative landowners made the fatal, cynical miscalculation that they could use his mass popularity to serve their own authoritarian goals.

2. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33? (8 marks)

3. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

4. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

5. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. (16 marks)

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Teacher Comment:
